

Day 7 — Doṣa Rhythms in a Day

Module: Doshas — Vāta, Pitta, Kapha · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: map the kapha-pitta-vāta cycle across morning/noon/evening hours.

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *doṣa* (IAST: doṣa; lit. “humour / functional principle”)

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **Project the doṣa clock.** On the board, draw a 24-hour ring divided into three two-period segments:
 - **Kapha hours:** 6–10 am and 6–10 pm — heavy, slow start; calm wind-down.
 - **Pitta hours:** 10 am–2 pm and 10 pm–2 am — sharp focus; metabolic peak.
 - **Vāta hours:** 2–6 am and 2–6 pm — light, mobile, creative.
2. **Source.** Aṣṭāṅga Hṛdaya, *Sūtrasthāna* 1.8 on *kāla-prabhāva* (time-of-day influence on doṣa).
3. **Match observations to hours.** “*When is your sharpest study time? When do you feel heaviest? When are dreams most active?*” Pair this to the chart. Most students will recognise the pitta-noon peak and the kapha-morning slump.
4. **Modern bridge.** Map onto circadian-rhythm research: cortisol peaks ~8 am (kapha-clearance), core body temperature peaks ~mid-afternoon (pitta), REM sleep dominates ~3–5 am (vāta).
5. **Independent work.** Each student sketches their own 24-hour clock and annotates which hours they feel each doṣa dominate. Compare in pairs.

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Build a Doṣa Rhythm Clock* (see [activities/](#)). Today's slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Doṣa Rhythms in a Day.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See `homework.md` for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 pañcabhūta).